# Maximo Select Documentation

Welcome to Maximo Select — a streamlined maintenance management system designed to help you track equipment, manage work, and keep operations running smoothly.

## What is Maximo Select?

Maximo Select is a ready-to-use SaaS solution that helps mid-market organizations:

- Track assets and equipment
- Create and complete work orders
- Schedule preventive maintenance
- Manage parts inventory
- Monitor performance

No installation. No configuration. No customization needed. Just sign in and start working.

## Who is this for?

- Technicians — Find and complete your work orders
- Supervisors — Plan, assign, and track maintenance work
- Inventory clerks — Manage parts and supplies
- Administrators — Load data and set up users

## Get started in minutes

New to Maximo Select? Start here:

1. What can I do with Maximo Select? (start-fast/what-can-i-do/overview.html)
2. Complete your first task (start-fast/first-task/technician-first-task.html)
3. Learn the basics (start-fast/basics/what-is-asset.html)

## Find what you need

### 🟦 Start fast

Get from zero to first value in minutes.

Explore Start Fast → (start-fast/what-can-i-do/overview.html)

### 🟩 Get work done

Complete everyday maintenance tasks.

Explore Get Work Done → (get-work-done/plan-work/plan-recurring-maintenance.html)

### 🟨 Improve results

Make your maintenance program more efficient.

Explore Improve Results → (improve-results/improve-work/reduce-downtime.html)

### 🟧 Work smarter

Use AI, automation, and insights to scale.

Explore Work Smarter → (work-smarter/ai-automation/ai-improve-maintenance.html)

### 🟥 Get answers

Find quick answers to common questions.

Browse All Questions → (get-answers/index.html)

## Need help?

- In the product: Click the help icon (?) in the top right
- For a specific field: Click the field name or press Alt+F1
- Can't find an answer?: Check the Get Answers (get-answers/index.html) section

Ready to start? Go to What can I do with Maximo Select? (start-fast/what-can-i-do/overview.html)



(../../images/utilities_600x150.jpg)

# What is Maximo Select?

Maximo Select helps you manage maintenance work from start to finish.

Whether you're fixing equipment, tracking parts, or planning preventive maintenance, everything you need is in one place.

## What problems does it solve?

Maximo Select helps you move from reactive "run-to-fail" maintenance to organized, preventive maintenance:

- Stop losing track of work: all work orders in one system, not scattered across spreadsheets or paper
- Prevent equipment failures: schedule maintenance before problems happen
- Know what you have: track all your assets and their maintenance history
- Control parts inventory: see what's in stock and what's been used
- Make better decisions: use data to understand what's working and what needs attention

## What can different roles do?

### Technician

- View your assigned work orders

- Complete tasks and record what you did
- Report time and materials used
- Request parts from inventory
- Add notes and photos to work orders

First task: Complete a work order (../first-task/what-is-my-first-task.html#as-a-technician-complete-a-work-order)

## Supervisor

- Create and assign work orders
- Schedule preventive maintenance
- Track work progress and completion
- Monitor team workload
- Review maintenance costs and performance

First task: Assign and track work (../first-task/what-is-my-first-task.html#as-a-supervisor-assign-and-track-work)

## Inventory clerk

- Issue parts to work orders
- Track stock levels and locations
- Receive new inventory
- Perform stock counts
- Monitor part usage

First task: Issue a part (../first-task/what-is-my-first-task.html#as-an-inventory-clerk-issue-a-part)

## Administrator

- Load user and asset data
- Set up communication templates
- Configure AI features
- Manage user access
- Customize notifications

First task: Load user data (../first-task/what-is-my-first-task.html#as-an-administrator-load-user-data)

## What if I run into issues?

If you need help:

1. For a specific field: Click the field name or press Alt+F1 to see field-level help.
2. In the product: Click the help icon (?) in the top right corner.
3. In these docs: Check the Get Answers (../../get-answers/index.html) section.
4. Still stuck?: Submit feedback through the help menu.

## Related topics

- What is my first task? (../first-task/what-is-my-first-task.html)
- What are the basic concepts? (../basics/what-are-basic-concepts.html)
- Get answers to common questions (../../get-answers/index.html)

# What are the basic concepts?

Understanding a few key concepts helps you work more effectively in Maximo Select. These are the building blocks you'll use every day.

## Quick reference

| CONCEPT | WHAT IT IS | EXAMPLE |
|---|---|---|
| Asset | Equipment you maintain | Pump #5, HVAC Unit 3 |
| Work order | Instruction to do work | WO12345: Repair Pump #5 |
| Location | Where work happens | Building 3, Room 201 |

## What is an asset?

An asset is any piece of equipment, machinery, or infrastructure that your organization maintains. Assets are the physical things you work on.

### Examples of assets

- Production equipment: Manufacturing machines, assembly lines, conveyors
- Facilities: HVAC systems, elevators, lighting systems
- Vehicles: Trucks, forklifts, company cars
- IT equipment: Servers, network devices, computers
- Infrastructure: Pumps, motors, transformers, generators

### Why assets matter

- Track maintenance history for each piece of equipment
- Schedule preventive maintenance
- Monitor asset condition and performance

- Plan for replacements and upgrades
- Calculate total cost of ownership

### Key asset information

Each asset record includes: - Asset number: Unique identifier - Description: What it is - Location: Where it's installed - Status: Operating, down, retired, etc. - Specifications: Technical details - Maintenance history: All work performed - Parent/child relationships: How assets connect

### Asset hierarchy

Assets can be organized in hierarchies: - Parent asset: Main equipment (e.g., production line) - Child assets: Components (e.g., motor, conveyor belt) - Location: Where the asset is installed

This helps you understand how equipment relates and track maintenance at different levels.

Bob comment: A diagram showing asset hierarchy would be useful here.

## What is a work order?

A work order is a request or instruction to perform maintenance work. It's the central document that tracks everything about a maintenance job.

### Types of work orders

- Corrective maintenance: Fix something that broke
- Preventive maintenance: Scheduled routine maintenance
- Predictive maintenance: Work based on condition monitoring
- Project work: Installations, upgrades, modifications
- Inspections: Regular checks and assessments

### Why work orders matter

- Assign work to the right people
- Track what work was done
- Record labor hours and costs
- Document parts used

- Maintain history of all maintenance
- Measure performance and productivity

### Key work order information

Each work order includes: - Work order number: Unique identifier - Description: What needs to be done - Asset or location: Where to do the work - Priority: How urgent it is - Status: Assigned, in progress, completed, etc. - Assigned to: Who should do the work - Scheduled dates: When it should be done - Instructions: Detailed steps or procedures

### Work order lifecycle

1. Created: Work order is generated
2. Approved: Supervisor approves the work
3. Assigned: Technician is assigned
4. In Progress: Work has started
5. Completed: Work is finished
6. Closed: Final approval and closure

Bob comment: A flowchart showing work order lifecycle would be useful here.

### Work order vs. work request

- Work request: Someone reports a problem or need
- Work order: Approved request with assigned resources

Not all requests become work orders - some may be rejected, combined, or deferred.

## What is a location?

A location is a physical place where work is performed or assets are installed. Locations help you organize and find equipment.

### Types of locations

- Operating locations: Where assets are installed and running
- Storerooms: Where parts and materials are kept

- Service locations: Customer sites or service areas
- Staging areas: Temporary locations for work preparation

### Why locations matter

- Find equipment quickly
- Organize maintenance by area
- Assign work by location
- Track costs by facility or department
- Plan work routes efficiently
- Manage access and safety

### Key location information

Each location record includes: - Location code: Unique identifier - Description: What/where it is - Type: Operating, storeroom, etc. - Parent location: Larger area it's part of - Assets: Equipment at this location - Access information: How to get there

### Location hierarchy

Locations are organized in hierarchies: - Site: Entire facility (e.g., "Plant A") - Building: Specific building (e.g., "Building 3") - Floor: Level within building (e.g., "Floor 2") - Room: Specific room (e.g., "Room 201") - Area: Section within room (e.g., "Northeast corner")

This helps you navigate large facilities and organize work by area.

Bob comment: A diagram showing location hierarchy would be useful here.

### Location vs. asset

- Location: The place (e.g., "Room 101")
- Asset: The equipment (e.g., "Pump #5")
- Relationship: Asset is installed at location

Some work orders are for locations (e.g., "Paint room 101") rather than specific assets.

## How these concepts work together

## Example scenario

Problem: A pump stops working

1. Asset: Pump #5 (the equipment that failed)
2. Location: Building 3, Room 201 (where the pump is)
3. Work order: Created to repair Pump #5
4. Assigned to a technician
5. Scheduled for today
6. Parts ordered from storeroom
7. Work completed and documented

## Finding information

When you need to: - Find equipment: Search by asset number or location - See maintenance history: Look at asset record - Check what work is needed: Review work orders - Know where to go: Check location details

## Organizing your work

- By asset: All work for specific equipment
- By location: All work in an area
- By work order: Specific job details

# Related topics

- What is Maximo Select? (../what-can-i-do/overview.html)
- What is my first task? (../first-task/what-is-my-first-task.html)
- How do I complete a job? (../../get-work-done/complete-work/complete-job.html)
- How do I track asset history? (../../get-work-done/manage-assets/track-asset-history.html)

# What is my first task?

Get started quickly with a task designed for your role.

Each first task helps you learn the basics while accomplishing something useful. Choose your role below to see your recommended first task.

## As a technician, complete a work order

Your first task: Find and complete an assigned work order.

### What you'll learn

- How to find your assigned work
- How to update work order status
- How to record what you did
- How to close a completed work order

### What to do:

1. Log into Maximo Select.
2. Go to Work Orders or My Assigned Work.
3. Choose a simple work order to start (look for status "Assigned" or "In Progress").
4. Click to open the work order details.
5. Change status to "In Progress".
6. Review what needs to be done.
7. Check if you need any parts or tools.
8. Perform the maintenance task.
9. Add notes about what you did.
10. Record time spent (labor hours).
11. Add any parts you used.

12. Update meter readings if applicable.
13. Change status to "Completed".
14. Verify all information is recorded.
15. Submit for approval if required.

### 💡 Tips for success

- Start with a simple preventive maintenance task
- Ask your supervisor if you're unsure about anything
- Take photos to document your work
- Record information as you go, not at the end

### What's next?

Once you've completed your first work order, try: - Completing a more complex work order - Requesting parts for a job - Reporting a problem you discovered

## As a supervisor, assign and track work

Your first task: Assign a work order to a technician and track its progress.

### What you'll learn

- How to view unassigned work
- How to assign work to technicians
- How to check work status
- How to monitor team workload

### What to do:

1. Log into Maximo Select.
2. Go to Work Orders.
3. Filter for unassigned work orders.
4. Review priority and due dates.

5. Choose a work order that needs assignment.
6. Review the work details.
7. Check required skills or crafts.
8. Consider technician skills and current workload.
9. Verify technician availability.
10. Open the work order.
11. Add the technician to labor section.
12. Set expected start date.
13. Add any special instructions.
14. Save the assignment.
15. Monitor work order status for updates.
16. Review when work is completed.
17. Check labor hours and parts usage.
18. Approve if required.

### 💡 Tips for success

- Balance workload across your team
- Assign work based on skills and location
- Set clear expectations and deadlines
- Check in regularly on work progress
- Use dashboards to monitor team performance

### What's next?

After assigning your first work order, try: - Creating a new work order - Planning preventive maintenance - Reviewing team performance metrics

---

## As an inventory clerk, issue a part

Your first task: Issue a part from the storeroom to a work order.

### What you'll learn

- How to find parts in inventory
- How to check stock levels
- How to issue parts to work orders
- How inventory transactions are recorded

## What to do:

1. Check for work orders needing parts.
2. Review the parts list.
3. Note the work order number.
4. Go to Inventory application.
5. Search by item number or description.
6. Check the storeroom location.
7. Verify quantity available.
8. Go to the storeroom.
9. Find the correct bin location.
10. Verify the item number matches.
11. Check the part condition.
12. In Maximo, open the inventory record.
13. Click Issue action.
14. Enter the work order number.
15. Specify quantity to issue.
16. Confirm the transaction.
17. Check that inventory balance decreased.
18. Verify work order shows the material.
19. Confirm cost was recorded.
20. Hand over the physical part to technician.

## 💡 Tips for success

- Always verify item numbers before issuing
- Keep storeroom organized and labeled

- Issue parts promptly to avoid work delays
- Record transactions immediately
- Check for reorder needs after issuing

### What's next?

After issuing your first part, try: - Receiving a shipment into inventory - Performing a cycle count - Transferring parts between storerooms

---

## As an administrator, load user data

Your first task: Add a new user to the system and assign them appropriate access.

### What you'll learn

- How to create user accounts
- How to assign security groups
- How to set up user profiles
- How to verify user access

### What to do:

1. Gather employee details (name, email, ID).
2. Determine their role (technician, supervisor, etc.).
3. Identify required access level.
4. Note their department and location.
5. Go to Security > Users.
6. Click to add new user.
7. Enter user ID (usually employee ID).
8. Add name and contact information.
9. Set default site and storeroom.
10. Add user to appropriate security group:
    - Technician group for field workers
    - Supervisor group for team leads

    - Clerk group for inventory staff
    - Admin group for administrators
11. Verify group permissions match role needs.
12. Configure default settings.
13. Set language preference.
14. Assign default start center.
15. Configure email notifications.
16. Have user log in to test.
17. Verify they can access required applications.
18. Check that permissions work correctly.
19. Confirm they can perform their role tasks.
20. Document the setup.

### 💡 Tips for success

- Use consistent naming conventions for user IDs
- Follow principle of least privilege (minimum access needed)
- Test accounts before giving to users
- Keep security group assignments organized
- Document any custom permissions

### What's next?

After creating your first user, try: - Setting up a security group - Configuring email notifications - Creating a custom start center - Bulk loading multiple users

## Need help?

If you get stuck on your first task: - Check the detailed how-to guides in "Get Work Done" - Ask your supervisor or administrator - Review the basics in "What are the basic concepts?" - Contact support if you encounter technical issues

## Related topics

- What is Maximo Select? (../what-can-i-do/overview.html)
- What are the basic concepts? (../basics/what-are-basic-concepts.html)
- How do I complete a job? (../../get-work-done/complete-work/complete-job.html)

# How do I plan recurring maintenance?

Create a schedule that automatically generates work orders. The system creates work orders for you based on time (every 30 days) or equipment use (every 500 hours).

This helps you maintain equipment before it breaks. You set up the schedule once. The system does the rest.

Bob comment: A diagram showing the PM workflow (create PM → schedule → auto-generate work orders → complete work → next work order) would be useful here.

## When to use this

Use recurring maintenance when you need to: - Inspect or service equipment regularly - Maintain equipment based on how much it runs - Follow manufacturer maintenance schedules - Prevent equipment breakdowns - Keep consistent maintenance records

## How to set it up

### Step 1: Create a job plan (recommended)

A job plan lists the work steps, parts needed, and time required. It keeps the work consistent every time.

You can skip this step, but job plans make maintenance easier.

### Step 2: Create the maintenance record

1. Open the Preventive Maintenance application
2. Choose the equipment or location
3. Describe the maintenance work clearly

### Step 3: Set the schedule

Choose how often to do the work:

Time-based schedule - Every 30 days - Every 2 weeks - Every 6 months

Usage-based schedule - Every 500 operating hours - Every 1000 cycles - Every 200 miles

Combined schedule - Every 6 months OR 300 hours (whichever comes first) - Every year OR 1000 hours (whichever comes first)

### Step 4: Set lead time (optional)

Lead time tells the system when to create the work order before it's due.

Example: Set 7 days lead time. The system creates the work order a week early. This gives you time to get parts and schedule workers.

### Step 5: Add the job plan

Link your job plan to the schedule. Each work order will include the same steps and parts list.

Bob comment: A video showing how to create a simple time-based PM would be useful here.

## What happens next

After you activate the schedule:

1. The system creates work orders automatically
2. Each work order includes your job plan steps
3. Technicians complete the work
4. The system calculates the next due date
5. The system creates the next work order

The cycle repeats until you stop it.

## Tips for success

Start simple Begin with time-based schedules. Add usage-based schedules later.

Use job plans Job plans keep maintenance consistent. Everyone follows the same steps.

Set realistic lead times Too short: You won't have time to prepare. Too long: Work orders pile up.

Review and adjust Check if your schedules work well. Adjust them based on how equipment performs.

## Related topics

- How do I decide what work should be done? (decide-what-work.html)
- How do I schedule work? (schedule-work.html)
- What is a work order? (../../start-fast/basics/what-are-basic-concepts.html#what-is-a-work-order)
- How do I complete a job? (../complete-work/complete-job.html)

# How do I decide what work should be done?

Create job plans that list the steps, parts, and tools for common maintenance tasks. Job plans work like templates. They keep work consistent every time.

You plan the work once. Then you reuse the plan. This saves time and reduces mistakes.

Bob comment: A diagram showing how job plans flow into work orders would be useful here.

## When to use job plans

Use job plans for: - Tasks you do regularly (monthly inspections) - Work with multiple steps - Jobs that need specific parts or tools - Tasks where safety matters - Scheduled maintenance

## What goes in a job plan

Include these items:

Work description What you need to do and why.

Task list Step-by-step instructions.

Labor estimates How many people and hours you need.

Required materials Parts and supplies you need.

Tools Special equipment or tools.

Safety information Hazards and safety steps.

## How to create and use job plans

### Create the job plan

1. Open the Job Plans application
2. Add a clear name and description

3. List all work tasks in order
4. Add labor, materials, and tools

### Use with scheduled maintenance

Attach job plans to your maintenance schedules. Work orders include the job plan automatically.

### Use with work orders

Add job plans to individual work orders. Technicians see all steps and materials.

### Keep plans current

Review completed work. Update job plans based on what actually happened. Add missing steps or materials.

Bob comment: A video showing how to create a simple job plan would be useful here.

## Why job plans help

Everyone does the work the same way No confusion about steps or procedures.

Work goes faster No time spent figuring out what to do.

You get the right parts All materials are listed upfront.

Training is easier New workers have clear instructions.

Costs are predictable You know time and materials in advance.

## Tips for success

Start with common tasks Create plans for work you do most often.

Keep it simple Use clear, short instructions.

Add safety notes Include warnings for dangerous work.

Update regularly Change plans based on worker feedback.

Use for all scheduled work Every maintenance schedule should have a job plan.

## Related topics

- How do I plan recurring maintenance? (plan-recurring-maintenance.html)
- How do I schedule work? (schedule-work.html)
- How do I complete a job? (../complete-work/complete-job.html)
- What is a work order? (../../start-fast/basics/what-are-basic-concepts.html#what-is-a-work-order)

# How do I schedule work?

Use calendars to set working hours. Use routes to group inspection points. This helps you plan when work happens and organize inspections efficiently.

Calendars track when your team works. Routes let you create inspection work orders for multiple items at once.

## Calendars: Set working time

Calendars show when work can happen. They include: - Working days and hours - Shifts (7 AM - 3 PM, 3 PM - 11 PM) - Holidays and shutdowns - Days off

Bob comment: A diagram showing how calendars connect to labor, locations, and work scheduling would be useful here.

### When to use calendars

Use calendars to: - Set standard work shifts - Track holidays and shutdowns - Schedule work during available hours - Assign work when people are working - Calculate realistic finish times

### How to set up calendars

Step 1: Create shifts - Set working days (Monday-Friday) - Set start and end times (7:00 AM - 3:00 PM) - Enter total work hours per day

Step 2: Create the calendar - Make a calendar for your organization - Add shifts to show the work schedule - Mark holidays and days off

Step 3: Assign calendars - Apply calendars to your team members - Apply to locations or equipment if needed - System uses calendars to schedule work

## Routes: Group inspection points

Routes are lists of items that need regular inspection. Create one route. Generate work orders for all items at once.

Bob comment: A diagram showing a route with multiple stops and how it generates work orders would be useful here.

### When to use routes

Use routes for: - Regular inspection rounds (daily equipment checks) - Safety inspections at multiple locations - Maintenance on similar equipment - Any work that follows a set path

### How to set up routes

Step 1: Create the route 1. Open the Routes application 2. Add a clear name (like "Daily Production Line Inspection") 3. List all items to inspect (called "stops")

Step 2: Use the route - Add the route to a work order - System creates work orders for each stop - Add to a maintenance schedule for automatic use - Choose: separate work orders or one work order with multiple tasks

Step 3: Complete the work - Technicians follow the route - They complete inspections at each stop - All work tracks under the main work order

Bob comment: A video showing how to create a simple inspection route would be useful here.

## Tips for success

For calendars: - Start simple. Match your standard work week. - Add holidays as you go. - Update calendars when shifts change.

For routes: - Group equipment that's close together. - Keep routes focused. Don't mix unrelated items. - Update routes when equipment changes. - Use clear names.

## Related topics

- How do I plan recurring maintenance? (plan-recurring-maintenance.html)
- How do I decide what work should be done? (decide-what-work.html)
- How do I complete a job? (../complete-work/complete-job.html)
- How do I assign the right people? (../organize-people/assign-right-people.html)

# How do I find my work?

Use work queues to see all your assigned work in one place. Work queues group similar tasks so you can quickly find what needs to be done.

Work queues show only the work that matters to you. No searching through everything.

Bob comment: A screenshot showing the work queue view with filtered work orders would be useful here.

## When to use work queues

Work queues help you: - See all work assigned to you - Find urgent or overdue work fast - Focus on specific work types (inspections, repairs) - Track work for your team or location - Act on multiple items at once

## How work queues work

Your administrator creates work queues that filter and show relevant work. Common types:

My work orders All work orders assigned to you.

Overdue work Work that should be done already.

High priority Urgent work that needs immediate attention.

Team work Work assigned to your crew or department.

Pending approval Work waiting for your review.

Bob comment: A diagram showing how work queues filter and organize different types of work would be useful here.

## Finding your work

### Step 1: Open work queues

1. Go to the Operational Dashboard
2. Find the Work Queues section
3. Each queue shows how many items it has

### Step 2: Pick a queue

1. Click on a work queue
2. See all items with key details (status, priority, due date)
3. Use filters to narrow down more if needed

### Step 3: Open a work order

1. Click on any item
2. Read the work description
3. Check what you need
4. Start work when ready

## Using the mobile app

On your phone or tablet: - Open the Maximo Mobile app - Go to your assigned work - Work orders sync automatically - Work offline if needed - Changes sync when you're back online

Bob comment: A video showing how to find and open work on mobile would be useful here.

## Tips for staying organized

At the start of each shift: Check your work queues.

Prioritize: Do urgent and overdue items first.

Update status: Change status as you work.

Add notes: Write about issues or delays.

Close promptly: Finish completed work so it doesn't clutter your queue.

## What if I don't see my work?

If work is missing: - Check that it's assigned to you - Check the work order status (might be on hold) - Refresh your work queue - Ask your supervisor if it's still missing

## Related topics

- How do I complete a job? (complete-job.html)
- What if I can't complete a task? (cant-complete-task.html)
- What is my first task? (../../start-fast/first-task/what-is-my-first-task.html#as-a-technician-complete-a-work-order)
- What is a work order? (../../start-fast/basics/what-are-basic-concepts.html#what-is-a-work-order)

# How do I complete a job?

Open your work order. Do the work. Record what you did. Mark it complete. The system tracks your time and parts automatically.

Good records help everyone. They track costs and provide history for future work.

Bob comment: A diagram showing the work order lifecycle (assigned → in progress → complete → closed) would be useful here.

## Steps to complete work

### Step 1: Find and open your work order

- Go to your work queue or mobile app
- Look for work assigned to you
- Open the work order

### Step 2: Start the work

- Click Start Work to track time
- Read the job plan or instructions
- Check you have all parts and tools
- Note any safety requirements

Bob comment: A video showing how to start and track time on a work order would be useful here.

### Step 3: Do the work

- Follow the job plan steps
- Complete any checklists
- Take photos of issues or finished work
- Note any problems

### Step 4: Record what you did

Add work details: - Describe what you found and fixed - Be specific (helps the next person) - Note any follow-up work needed

Record materials: - Add parts from inventory - System tracks costs automatically - Request more parts if needed

Confirm time: - System tracks time from when you started - Adjust for breaks if needed - Time is used for costs and planning

Bob comment: A screenshot showing where to add notes and materials would be useful here.

### Step 5: Mark it complete

- Click Complete Work when done
- System stops tracking time
- Work order goes to your supervisor
- Supervisor closes it after review

## What to include in your notes

Good notes help everyone:

What you found: "Bearing was worn and making noise"

What you did: "Replaced bearing, lubricated shaft, tested operation"

Results: "Equipment running smoothly, no unusual noise"

Follow-up needed: "Monitor for vibration over next week"

## Using checklists

If your work order has a checklist: - Complete each item as you go - Mark pass or fail for each point - Add notes for any failures - Take photos of issues - Finish all items before completing work

## Working offline (mobile)

On the mobile app: - Start work without internet - Complete tasks and add notes offline - Take photos (saved on your device) - Changes sync when you're back online

## Tips for success

Start promptly: Time tracking is more accurate.

Add notes as you work: Don't wait until the end.

Take photos: Show problems or finished repairs.

Record all parts: Even small items matter.

Mark complete quickly: Don't leave work orders open.

## What happens after you complete work

After you mark complete: - Your supervisor gets notified - They review your work and notes - They close the work order if correct - Work order becomes part of equipment history - Costs are calculated and recorded

## Related topics

- How do I find my work? (find-work.html)
- What if I can't complete a task? (cant-complete-task.html)
- How do I issue parts to a job? (../manage-inventory/issue-parts.html)
- What is a work order? (../../start-fast/basics/what-are-basic-concepts.html#what-is-a-work-order)

# What if I can't complete a task?

Add notes explaining the issue, change the work order status to show it's blocked, and notify your supervisor. The work order stays open until the problem is resolved.

Sometimes you can't finish work because parts aren't available, you need help, or you discover a bigger problem. That's normal. The important thing is to document what's blocking you so others can help resolve it.

## Common reasons you can't complete work

### Missing parts or materials

Problem: You need parts that aren't in stock

What to do:

- Request the parts through the work order
- Add notes about what's needed
- Change status to "Waiting on Parts"
- Notify your supervisor
- Move to other work while waiting

### Need additional help or skills

Problem: The job requires expertise you don't have

What to do:

- Add notes describing what's needed
- Change status to "Waiting on Assignment"
- Contact your supervisor to assign additional help
- Document what you've completed so far

## Equipment or tools not available

Problem: You need special tools or equipment that aren't available

What to do:

- List the required tools in your notes
- Change status to "On Hold"
- Notify your supervisor
- Check if tools can be borrowed or rented

## Discovered a bigger problem

Problem: You found additional issues that need to be addressed

What to do:

- Document the new problem with photos if possible
- Add detailed notes about what you found
- Discuss with your supervisor whether to:
- Expand the current work order
- Create a new work order for the additional work
- Update the work order status appropriately

Bob comment: A flowchart showing decision points when you can't complete work would be useful here.

## Safety concerns

Problem: Unsafe conditions prevent you from completing work

What to do: - Stop work immediately - Document the safety issue - Change status to "On Hold" - Notify your supervisor right away - Follow your organization's safety procedures

## Access issues

Problem: You can't access the equipment or location

What to do: - Note why access is blocked - Change status to "Waiting" - Contact whoever can provide access - Notify your supervisor

## How to document the issue

When you can't complete work, add clear notes:

What to include: - What you were trying to do - What's blocking you - What you've already completed - What's still needed - Any photos of the problem

Example good note: "Replaced motor mount bolts 1-3. Bolt 4 is stripped and needs to be drilled out. Need drill and easy-out set. Completed 75% of work. Equipment is safe to leave overnight but should not be operated."

Bob comment: A screenshot showing where to add detailed notes and change status would be useful here.

## Changing work order status

Use the right status to show what's blocking you:

- On Hold: General hold, waiting for something
- Waiting on Parts: Specifically waiting for materials
- Waiting on Assignment: Need additional people or skills
- Waiting: Other reasons (access, approval, etc.)

Your supervisor can see these statuses and help resolve the issue.

## What happens next

After you update the status and add notes: - Your supervisor is notified - They can see exactly what's blocking you - They work to resolve the issue (order parts, assign help, etc.) - You're notified when you can continue - Work order stays in your queue until resolved

## Tips for handling blocked work

- Document issues as soon as you discover them
- Be specific about what's needed
- Take photos of problems
- Don't leave work orders open without notes

- Check back periodically on blocked work
- Update notes if situation changes

## Preventing future blocks

Help prevent similar issues: - Review work orders before starting - Check parts availability first - Verify you have the right tools - Ask questions if instructions are unclear - Report recurring problems to your supervisor

## Related topics

- How do I complete a job? (complete-job.html)
- How do I find my work? (find-work.html)
- How do I issue parts to a job? (../manage-inventory/issue-parts.html)
- What happens if stock is incorrect? (../manage-inventory/stock-incorrect.html)

# How do I track asset history?

View all work orders, meter readings, and maintenance activities for any asset in one place.

## Quick reference

| WHAT YOU CAN SEE | WHY IT MATTERS |
| --- | --- |
| All work orders | Know what's been done |
| Meter readings | Track equipment usage |
| Costs | Understand maintenance expenses |
| Downtime | See when equipment was unavailable |
| Failures | Identify recurring problems |

Bob comment: A screenshot showing the asset history view with work orders and costs would be useful here.

## Why track asset history?

Asset history shows you the complete story of your equipment. You can see what maintenance was done, when it happened, and what it cost.

This helps you: - Spot problems that keep happening - Plan better maintenance schedules - Decide whether to repair or replace equipment - Estimate future maintenance costs

Every completed work order becomes part of the permanent record. This creates a reliable history you can use to make smart decisions.

## What's included in asset history?

The system automatically tracks these details for each asset:

Work orders All maintenance and repairs performed on the equipment.

Meter readings Equipment usage over time (hours run, cycles completed, miles driven).

Costs Labor, parts, and total maintenance expenses.

Downtime When equipment was out of service and for how long.

Failures Problems that occurred and how they were fixed.

Moves Location changes and transfers.

Specifications Technical details and attributes.

## When should I review asset history?

Check asset history when you need to:

- Understand why a problem keeps happening
- Plan preventive maintenance schedules
- Decide whether to repair or replace equipment
- Estimate maintenance costs for budgeting
- Troubleshoot current issues
- Prepare for audits or compliance reviews

## How do I view asset history?

### What to do:

1. Open the Assets application.
2. Search for the asset by name, number, or location.
3. Open the asset record.
4. Review the information you need:
5. Work history: See all completed work orders, who did the work, and costs
6. Meter readings: View usage trends and identify unusual patterns
7. Costs: See total maintenance costs and cost breakdown

Bob comment: A video showing how to navigate asset history and find specific information would be useful here.

## How do I use history to make decisions?

### Identify recurring problems

If you see the same issue repeatedly: - Review failure codes to spot patterns - Check if preventive maintenance needs adjustment - Consider if the problem indicates a larger issue - Evaluate if replacement is more cost-effective than continued repairs

### Plan preventive maintenance

Use history to: - See what maintenance has been done - Identify optimal maintenance intervals - Adjust schedules based on actual usage - Prevent problems before they occur

### Evaluate equipment performance

Track: - How often equipment goes down and for how long - Maintenance costs compared to equipment value - Reliability trends over time - Whether equipment meets performance expectations

Bob comment: A diagram showing how to use history data for decision-making would be useful here.

## 💡 Tips for success

For technicians: - Complete work orders promptly so history stays current - Add detailed notes about what you did - Record all parts used - Take photos of problems and repairs - Enter meter readings regularly

For supervisors: - Review and close work orders quickly - Make sure costs are accurate - Verify meter readings are current - Use consistent failure codes - Keep asset records up to date

## What if history is incomplete?

If asset history is missing or incomplete:

1. Check if work orders were closed properly.

2. Verify the asset number is correct.
3. Look for work orders under old asset numbers.
4. Contact your administrator if data needs to be corrected.
5. Start maintaining complete records going forward.

## Related topics

- What are the basic concepts? (../../start-fast/basics/what-are-basic-concepts.html)
- How do I classify assets? (classify-assets.html)
- What happens when an asset fails? (asset-fails.html)
- How do I complete a job? (../complete-work/complete-job.html)

# How do I classify assets?

Use classifications to group similar assets together and add detailed specifications.

## Quick reference

| TERM | WHAT IT MEANS |
| --- | --- |
| Classification | A category that describes what type of equipment you have (like "Pump" or "Motor") |
| Attribute | A specific detail about the equipment (like "Manufacturer" or "Capacity") |
| Hierarchy | How classifications are organized from broad to specific |

Bob comment: A diagram showing classification hierarchy (e.g., Equipment → Pumps → Centrifugal Pumps) would be useful here.

## Why classify assets?

Classifications help you organize equipment and track information consistently.

When you classify an asset, you can: - Group similar assets together - Search for all assets of a specific type - Store technical details in a standard way - Report on maintenance by equipment type - Match vendor or industry standards

For example, if you classify all your pumps the same way, you can easily find them, compare their maintenance costs, and track specifications consistently.

## How classifications work

### Classification hierarchy

Classifications are organized like a tree, from broad to specific:

- Top level: Broad categories (like "Equipment" or "Facilities")
- Mid level: Specific types (like "Pumps" or "Motors")
- Bottom level: Detailed subtypes (like "Centrifugal Pumps")

Example:

```
Equipment
  └─ Pumps
      ├─ Centrifugal Pumps
      ├─ Positive Displacement Pumps
      └─ Submersible Pumps
```

Use the most specific classification that fits your equipment. This makes it easier to find and manage.

### Attributes and specifications

Each classification can have attributes that define specific details:

- Manufacturer: Who made it
- Model number: Specific model
- Capacity: How much it can handle
- Voltage: Electrical requirements
- Serial number: Unique identifier

Once you add these details, they become searchable. You can find all pumps from a specific manufacturer or all motors with a certain voltage.

Bob comment: A screenshot showing how attributes appear on an asset record would be useful here.

## How do I classify an asset?

### What to do:

1. Open the Assets application.
2. Find the asset you want to classify.
3. Open the asset record.

4. Go to the Specifications tab.
5. Click to add a classification.
6. Browse or search for the right classification.
7. Fill in the attributes:
8. Complete all required attributes
9. Add optional attributes for more detail
10. Save the asset.

The system stores all classification data. The information appears on the asset record and becomes searchable.

Bob comment: A video showing how to classify an asset and add specifications would be useful here.

## 💡 Tips for success

### Choose the right classification

- Use the most specific classification that fits
- Don't use overly broad classifications (like just "Equipment")
- Be consistent across similar assets
- Follow your organization's standards

### Complete all relevant attributes

- Fill in as many attributes as possible
- More detail makes assets easier to find and manage
- Include manufacturer and model information
- Add technical specifications for maintenance planning

### Use consistent values

- Use the same format for similar data
- Example: Always use "HP" for horsepower, not "hp" or "Horsepower"
- Follow naming conventions

- This makes searching and reporting more accurate

## Common classifications

Typical classifications you might use:

- HVAC Systems: Heating, ventilation, air conditioning
- Pumps: Various pump types
- Motors: Electric motors
- Conveyors: Material handling equipment
- Compressors: Air and gas compressors
- Vehicles: Forklifts, trucks, carts
- Building Systems: Electrical, plumbing, structural

## How do I search by classification?

Once assets are classified, you can:

- Find all assets of a specific type
- Filter work orders by equipment classification
- Report on maintenance costs by classification
- Identify assets needing similar maintenance

This makes it easy to analyze maintenance patterns and costs for specific types of equipment.

## What if the classification doesn't exist?

If you need a classification that doesn't exist:

1. Check if a similar classification works.
2. Contact your administrator to create new classifications.
3. Don't create duplicate classifications.
4. Follow your organization's approval process.

## Related topics

- What are the basic concepts? (../../start-fast/basics/what-are-basic-concepts.html)
- How do I track asset history? (track-asset-history.html)
- What happens when an asset fails? (asset-fails.html)

# What happens when an asset fails?

Record the failure using failure codes, create a work order to fix it, and track downtime.

## Quick reference

| FAILURE CODE LEVEL | WHAT IT DESCRIBES | EXAMPLE |
|---|---|---|
| Failure class | Type of problem | Mechanical failure |
| Problem | What specifically failed | Bearing failure |
| Cause | Why it failed | Lack of lubrication |

Bob comment: A diagram showing the failure reporting workflow would be useful here.

## Why track failures?

When equipment fails, documenting what happened and why helps you understand reliability issues and prevent future problems.

Recording failures helps you: - Identify patterns (see if the same problem keeps happening) - Improve maintenance (adjust schedules to prevent failures) - Track costs (understand the true cost of equipment problems) - Make decisions (decide when to repair versus replace) - Analyze trends (report on reliability by equipment type) - Prevent recurrence (learn from past failures)

Failure codes provide a standardized way to track problems. This makes it easy to spot patterns and trends.

## How failure codes work

Failure codes are organized in three levels:

### 1. Failure class (Problem type)

What kind of problem occurred: - Mechanical failure - Electrical failure - Operational error - External cause

### 2. Problem (Specific issue)

What specifically failed: - Bearing failure - Motor burnout - Seal leak - Control malfunction

### 3. Cause (Why it failed)

Root cause of the failure: - Normal wear - Lack of lubrication - Overload - Manufacturing defect

Bob comment: A screenshot showing the failure code hierarchy would be useful here.

## How do I report a failure?

### What to do:

1. Create or open a work order:
2. If no work order exists, create one
3. If working on existing work order, use that
4. Record the failure:
5. Go to the Failure Reporting section
6. Select the failure class (problem type)
7. Choose the specific problem
8. Identify the cause
9. Add details:
10. Describe what happened
11. Note when the failure occurred
12. Record any damage or safety issues
13. Take photos if helpful

14. Track downtime:
15. Record when equipment went down
16. Note when it's back in service
17. System calculates total downtime
18. Complete the repair:
19. Fix the problem
20. Document what you did
21. Close the work order

Bob comment: A video showing how to report a failure on a work order would be useful here.

## How do I use failure data?

### Identify recurring problems

Review failure reports to find: - Equipment that fails frequently - Common failure modes - Patterns by time of year or usage - Whether maintenance schedules need adjustment

### Analyze failure trends

Look for: - Increasing failure rates (equipment wearing out) - Seasonal patterns - Failures after specific events - Cost trends over time

### Make informed decisions

Use failure data to: - Justify equipment replacement - Adjust preventive maintenance - Improve operating procedures - Train operators on common issues - Budget for repairs and replacements

Bob comment: A diagram showing how to use failure data for decision-making would be useful here.

## Common failure scenarios

### Premature failure

Equipment fails before expected: - Check if maintenance schedule is adequate - Review operating conditions - Verify proper installation - Consider if equipment is undersized

### Repeated failures

Same problem keeps happening: - Look for root cause, not just symptoms - Check if repairs are done correctly - Consider if operating conditions changed - Evaluate if equipment is right for the application

### Sudden catastrophic failure

Equipment fails without warning: - Review if warning signs were missed - Check if inspections are thorough enough - Consider adding condition monitoring - Evaluate if maintenance frequency is adequate

## 💡 Tips for success

Be specific: - Don't just say "broken" - describe what failed - Use correct failure codes - Include relevant details

Be consistent: - Use the same codes for similar failures - Follow your organization's standards - This makes trend analysis accurate

Be timely: - Report failures when they happen - Don't wait until work order is closed - Fresh details are more accurate

Include context: - Note operating conditions - Mention recent changes - Record environmental factors - Add photos of damage

## What if I don't know the cause?

If the cause isn't clear:

1. Use "Unknown" or "Under Investigation".
2. Add notes about what you observed.
3. Update the failure code when cause is determined.
4. Don't guess - inaccurate data is worse than incomplete data.

## Related topics

- How do I track asset history? (track-asset-history.html)
- How do I classify assets? (classify-assets.html)
- How do I complete a job? (../complete-work/complete-job.html)
- What are the basic concepts? (../../start-fast/basics/what-are-basic-concepts.html)

# How do I issue parts to a job?

Take parts from the storeroom and assign them to a work order.

## Quick reference

| METHOD | WHEN TO USE |
| --- | --- |
| From work order | Most common - when you're working on a job |
| From storeroom | When managing inventory directly |
| Mobile app | When working in the field |

Bob comment: A diagram showing the parts issue workflow would be useful here.

## Why issue parts properly?

When you issue parts correctly, the system: - Updates inventory levels automatically - Records costs to the work order - Tracks what materials were used - Helps with reordering decisions

This ensures accurate inventory counts and a complete record of what each job cost.

## When should I issue parts?

Issue parts when: - You're starting a job and need materials - You use parts during a repair - You want costs recorded to the work order

## How do I issue parts?

### Method 1: Issue from work order

This is the most common way to issue parts.

What to do:

1. Open your assigned work order.
2. Go to the Materials or Actuals tab.
3. Click to add a material.
4. Search for the item by number or description.
5. Select the correct item.
6. Enter how many you need.
7. Choose the storeroom location.
8. Click Issue.

The system checks if parts are available, deducts from inventory, adds cost to the work order, and records the transaction.

Bob comment: A video showing how to issue parts from a work order would be useful here.

## Method 2: Issue from storeroom

Use this when managing inventory directly.

What to do:

1. Open the Inventory application.
2. Search for the item you need.
3. Open the inventory record.
4. Click Issue action.
5. Enter the work order number.
6. Specify quantity.
7. Confirm the issue.

The system updates inventory balance, shows the material on the work order, and records the cost.

## Method 3: Use mobile app

On mobile devices: - Open your work order - Add materials as you use them - Scan barcodes if available - Changes sync automatically

Bob comment: A screenshot showing the mobile parts issue screen would be useful here.

## What happens when I issue parts?

The system automatically: - Reduces inventory (storeroom balance goes down) - Records cost (material cost added to work order) - Tracks usage (creates transaction history) - Updates reorder (triggers reorder if below minimum) - Logs who and when (records who issued and when)

## 💡 Tips for success

Before you start work: - Check the job plan for required materials - Verify parts are in stock - Reserve parts if needed for later - Request parts that aren't available

During the job: - Issue parts as you use them - Record actual quantities used - Return unused parts promptly - Note if you used different parts than planned

After completing work: - Verify all materials are recorded - Return any unused parts - Add notes about part usage - Close the work order

## Common scenarios

### Part not in stock

If the part you need isn't available:

1. Check other storeroom locations.
2. Request a purchase.
3. Use an alternate part if approved.
4. Update work order status to "Waiting on Parts".

### Used wrong quantity

If you issued too many or too few parts:

1. Issue additional parts if you need more.
2. Return unused parts to storeroom.

3. System adjusts inventory and costs.
4. Add notes explaining the change.

### Emergency issue

For urgent repairs:

1. Issue parts immediately.
2. Add to work order as soon as possible.
3. Don't skip recording - it affects inventory.
4. Explain urgency in notes.

Bob comment: A flowchart for handling parts issues would be useful here.

## How do I return unused parts?

If you have leftover parts:

What to do:

1. Go to the work order.
2. Find the issued material.
3. Click Return action.
4. Enter quantity to return.

The system increases inventory balance, adjusts cost on work order, and records the transaction.

## Why accurate parts tracking matters

For your organization: - Correct inventory counts - Accurate cost tracking - Better reorder planning - Reliable stock levels

For you: - Parts are available when needed - No delays waiting for materials - Clear record of what was used - Easier to find parts next time

## Related topics

- How do I track stock levels? (track-stock-levels.html)
- What happens if stock is incorrect? (stock-incorrect.html)
- How do I complete a job? (../complete-work/complete-job.html)
- What if I can't complete a task? (../complete-work/cant-complete-task.html)

# How do I track stock levels?

Monitor what's in your storerooms so you know what's available, what needs reordering, and where items are located.

## Quick reference

| BALANCE TYPE | WHAT IT MEANS |
| --- | --- |
| Current balance | Total quantity in storeroom (includes reserved items) |
| Available balance | What you can actually use (current minus reserved) |
| Reserved quantity | Parts allocated to work orders |
| Reorder point | Minimum level before reordering |

Bob comment: A dashboard showing key inventory metrics would be useful here.

## Why track stock levels?

Good inventory tracking prevents stockouts and ensures parts are available when you need them.

When you track stock levels, you can: - Know what's available right now - See what needs reordering - Find where items are located - Control costs - Optimize storeroom space

The system tracks quantities, costs, and locations automatically as items move in and out.

## What can I track?

The Inventory application shows:

Current balance How many items are in stock.

Location Which storeroom and bin.

Cost Current value of inventory.

Reorder status Items below minimum levels.

Reserved items Parts allocated to work orders.

Item condition For condition-enabled items.

Lot information For lotted items.

Usage history How items are being consumed.

## How do I view inventory levels?

### Check a specific item

What to do:

1. Open the Inventory application.
2. Search by item number or description.
3. Select the item.
4. View the information you need:
5. Current quantity on hand
6. Available balance (not reserved)
7. Cost information
8. Reorder details

If the item is in multiple storerooms, you can view all locations on one screen and compare quantities across sites.

Bob comment: A screenshot showing the inventory balance view would be useful here.

### Check storeroom contents

What to do:

1. Open the Storerooms application.
2. Select your storeroom.

3. View all items stocked there:
4. Current quantities
5. Items below reorder point
6. Reserved quantities
7. Items in pick lists

### View by bin or lot

For detailed tracking: - Bin level: See exactly where items are stored - Lot level: Track specific batches - Condition: Monitor item condition changes - Rotating assets: Track individual asset items

Bob comment: A diagram showing bin and lot tracking would be useful here.

## How do I understand inventory balances?

### Key balance types

Current balance - Total quantity in storeroom - Includes reserved items - Shows what you physically have

Available balance - Current balance minus reserved - What you can actually use - Updates as items are reserved

Reserved quantity - Parts allocated to work orders - Not available for other use - Released when work order closes

Picked quantity - Items in active pick lists - Being prepared for issue - Not yet issued to work order

## How do I monitor reorder needs?

### Reorder point system

The system tracks: - Reorder point: Minimum level before reordering - Lead time: How long to get new stock - Order quantity: How much to reorder - Safety stock: Buffer for unexpected demand

When balance drops below reorder point, the system flags the item. You can then generate a purchase request.

### Check items to reorder

What to do:

1. Filter for items below reorder point.
2. See recommended order quantities.
3. Check vendor information.
4. Review lead times.
5. Take action:
6. Create purchase requisition
7. Transfer from another storeroom
8. Adjust reorder settings if needed

Bob comment: A screenshot showing the reorder report would be useful here.

## How do I track item costs?

### Cost information available

For each item, see: - Average cost: Current average unit cost - Last cost: Most recent purchase price - Standard cost: Planned or budgeted cost - Total value: Quantity × cost

### How costs are calculated

Average cost method - Weighted average of all purchases - Updates with each receipt - Smooths price fluctuations - Most common method

Standard cost method - Fixed cost set in advance - Doesn't change with purchases - Variances tracked separately - Used for budgeting

## How do I monitor inventory usage?

### Usage tracking

The system records: - When parts are used (issue transactions) - What jobs used items (work orders) - How often items are needed (frequency) - Usage patterns over time (trends)

### Analyze usage

Use this information to: - Identify fast-moving items - Spot slow-moving inventory - Adjust stock levels - Improve reorder quantities - Reduce excess inventory

Bob comment: A graph showing usage trends would be useful here.

## Special inventory types

### Rotating items

For serialized assets: - Track individual items - Monitor asset condition - See installation history - Manage asset rotation

### Condition-enabled items

For items with varying conditions: - Track condition changes - Monitor value by condition - Issue by condition code - Manage condition transitions

### Lotted items

For batch-tracked items: - Track by lot number - Monitor expiration dates - Issue from specific lots - Maintain lot history

### Item kits

For grouped items: - Issue multiple items together - Track kit components - Maintain kit integrity - Simplify common issues

Bob comment: A comparison table of special item types would be useful here.

## 💡 Tips for success

Regular monitoring: - Check stock levels daily - Review reorder needs weekly - Analyze usage monthly - Audit inventory quarterly

Maintain accuracy: - Issue parts promptly - Return unused items - Perform cycle counts - Investigate discrepancies

Optimize levels: - Adjust reorder points based on usage - Reduce slow-moving inventory - Increase stock of critical items - Balance cost versus availability

Use reports: - Stock status reports - Reorder reports - Usage analysis - Cost reports - ABC analysis (prioritize high-value items)

## Common scenarios

### Item running low

When stock is getting low:

1. Check reorder settings.
2. Verify lead time.
3. Create purchase request.
4. Or transfer from another storeroom.
5. Update reorder point if needed.

### Excess inventory

If you have too much:

1. Review usage history.
2. Check for obsolete items.
3. Transfer to other locations.
4. Adjust reorder quantities.
5. Consider disposal if appropriate.

### Can't find item

If item shows in stock but you can't find it:

1. Check bin location.
2. Verify storeroom.
3. Look for reserved quantity.
4. Check pick lists.

5. Perform physical count.
6. Adjust if necessary.

Bob comment: A troubleshooting flowchart would be useful here.

## Why accurate tracking matters

Prevents stockouts: - Parts available when needed - No work delays - Better service levels - Fewer emergency orders

Controls costs: - Reduces excess inventory - Optimizes stock levels - Improves cash flow - Lowers carrying costs

Improves planning: - Better reorder decisions - Accurate budgeting - Informed purchasing - Efficient operations

## Related topics

- How do I issue parts to a job? (issue-parts.html)
- What happens if stock is incorrect? (stock-incorrect.html)
- How do I plan recurring maintenance? (../plan-work/plan-recurring-maintenance.html)
- How do I complete a job? (../complete-work/complete-job.html)

# What happens if stock is incorrect?

When physical inventory doesn't match system records, you need to investigate and correct it.

## Quick reference

| COMMON CAUSE | WHAT TO CHECK |
| --- | --- |
| Transaction errors | Parts issued but not recorded, returns not processed |
| Physical issues | Items misplaced, wrong bin locations, damaged items |
| System issues | Data entry mistakes, incomplete transactions |

Bob comment: A flowchart showing the inventory correction process would be useful here.

## Why fix inventory errors quickly?

Inventory discrepancies can cause stockouts, excess inventory, and inaccurate costs.

Fixing errors quickly ensures: - Accurate records - No work delays - Reliable stock levels - Correct cost tracking

Regular counting and prompt adjustments keep your inventory data trustworthy.

## What causes inventory errors?

### Transaction errors

- Parts issued but not recorded
- Returns not processed
- Wrong quantities entered

- Duplicate transactions
- Missing receipts

### Physical issues

- Items misplaced in storeroom
- Wrong bin locations
- Damaged or lost items
- Theft or shrinkage
- Items in wrong storeroom

### System issues

- Data entry mistakes
- Timing differences
- Incomplete transactions
- System errors
- Integration problems

Bob comment: A diagram showing common error sources would be useful here.

## How do I identify discrepancies?

### During work

You might notice: - Item shows in stock but can't find it - Physical count doesn't match system - Bin is empty but system shows quantity - Wrong item in labeled bin - Unexpected items in storeroom

### Through cycle counts

Regular counting reveals: - Quantity differences - Location errors - Missing items - Extra items - Condition issues

### From reports

System reports show: - Negative balances (impossible physically) - Unusually high balances - No movement for long periods - Frequent adjustments - Cost variances

Bob comment: A screenshot showing an inventory discrepancy report would be useful here.

## How do I investigate discrepancies?

### Step 1: Verify the physical count

Before adjusting the system:

Recount the item: - Check all bins for this item - Look in nearby locations - Verify item number matches - Check for similar items

Check for reserved items: - Items in pick lists - Parts allocated to work orders - Items being transferred - Staged materials

Look for recent transactions: - Issues not yet processed - Returns in progress - Receipts being entered - Transfers pending

Bob comment: A checklist for investigating discrepancies would be useful here.

### Step 2: Review transaction history

Check recent activity: - Issue transactions: Were parts recorded? - Receipts: Did everything get entered? - Returns: Were returns processed? - Transfers: Did transfers complete? - Adjustments: Previous corrections made?

Look for patterns: - Repeated errors with same item - Specific user or storeroom - Particular transaction type - Time of day issues occur

### Step 3: Check related records

Verify: - Work orders: Materials recorded correctly? - Purchase orders: All receipts entered? - Transfer orders: Completed properly? - Pick lists: Items picked and issued?

Bob comment: A diagram showing related records to check would be useful here.

## How do I correct inventory?

### Make adjustments

Once you've verified the error:

What to do:

1. Open the Inventory application.
2. Find the item.
3. Go to the storeroom with error.
4. Use Adjust Balance action.
5. Enter correct physical quantity.
6. System calculates difference.
7. Add reason for adjustment.
8. Include detailed notes.

The system updates balance, adjusts cost, records transaction, and creates audit trail.

Bob comment: A video showing how to adjust inventory would be useful here.

### Adjustment best practices

Always document: - What you found - What you expected - Why the error occurred - Who discovered it - When it was found - Corrective action taken

Get approval if needed: - Large adjustments - High-value items - Frequent corrections - Unusual circumstances

Follow up: - Prevent recurrence - Train if needed - Improve processes - Monitor for patterns

## Types of adjustments

### Quantity adjustments

Increase balance: - Found items not recorded - Receipt was missed - Return not processed - Transfer not completed

Decrease balance: - Items issued but not recorded - Damaged or lost items - Theft or shrinkage - Items moved to another location

### Location adjustments

Moving items: - Wrong bin recorded - Reorganizing storeroom - Consolidating locations - Correcting bin assignments

### Cost adjustments

Correcting costs: - Wrong price entered - Cost method changed - Vendor price correction - Currency adjustments

Bob comment: A table comparing adjustment types would be useful here.

## How do I prevent inventory errors?

### Good practices

At issue time: - Record transactions immediately - Verify quantities - Check item numbers - Confirm locations - Complete transactions fully

At receipt time: - Count carefully - Match to purchase order - Verify item numbers - Put in correct location - Record promptly

During returns: - Process immediately - Verify condition - Return to correct bin - Update system - Note any issues

### Regular cycle counting

Count frequently: - High-value items weekly - Fast-moving items monthly - All items quarterly - Random spot checks

Count systematically: - Follow schedule - Use count books - Verify before adjusting - Document findings - Analyze patterns

Bob comment: A sample cycle count schedule would be useful here.

### Storeroom organization

Keep organized: - Clear bin labels - Logical layout - Similar items separated - Regular housekeeping - Defined locations

Control access: - Authorized personnel only - Proper training - Clear procedures - Accountability - Security measures

## Handling specific scenarios

### Negative balance

If system shows negative quantity:

1. This shouldn't happen physically.
2. Indicates transaction error.
3. Review recent issues.
4. Check for duplicate transactions.
5. Correct immediately.
6. Investigate cause.

### Large discrepancy

For significant differences:

1. Don't adjust immediately.
2. Investigate thoroughly.
3. Get supervisor approval.
4. Document extensively.
5. Implement prevention.
6. Monitor closely.

### Recurring errors

If same item has frequent issues:

1. Analyze error pattern.
2. Identify root cause.
3. Fix process problem.
4. Retrain if needed.

5. Consider item changes.
6. Monitor improvement.

Bob comment: A decision tree for handling different error types would be useful here.

## What's the impact of inventory errors?

### On operations

Stockouts: - Work delays - Emergency orders - Higher costs - Service issues

Excess inventory: - Wasted space - Tied-up cash - Obsolescence risk - Carrying costs

### On costs

Direct costs: - Incorrect work order costs - Wrong inventory valuation - Budget variances - Financial reporting errors

Indirect costs: - Time investigating - Emergency purchases - Lost productivity - Customer dissatisfaction

### On planning

Poor decisions: - Wrong reorder quantities - Incorrect stock levels - Bad purchasing decisions - Inefficient operations

Bob comment: An infographic showing error impacts would be useful here.

## When should I perform physical inventory?

### Full physical count

Do complete inventory when: - Annual audit required - Major discrepancies found - System implementation - Storeroom reorganization - Change in responsibility

### Cycle counting

Regular partial counts: - Less disruptive - Continuous accuracy - Catches errors early - Maintains reliability - Spreads workload

## How do I use count books?

Count books help organize counting: - Group items logically - Schedule counts - Assign counters - Track completion - Record results - Analyze variances

The system can: - Generate count books - Assign to users - Track progress - Record counts - Calculate differences - Create adjustments

Bob comment: A screenshot showing a count book would be useful here.

## 💡 Tips for success

Daily habits: - Record transactions immediately - Verify before confirming - Return items promptly - Keep storeroom organized - Report issues quickly

Weekly tasks: - Review high-value items - Check reorder items - Spot check locations - Investigate variances - Update procedures

Monthly activities: - Analyze error patterns - Review adjustment reports - Conduct cycle counts - Train as needed - Improve processes

## Related topics

- How do I track stock levels? (track-stock-levels.html)
- How do I issue parts to a job? (issue-parts.html)
- How do I complete a job? (../complete-work/complete-job.html)
- What if I can't complete a task? (../complete-work/cant-complete-task.html)

# How do I detect issues early?

Placeholder — Content to be completed

This topic will cover: Condition Monitoring

Information needed: - Detailed workflow from Maximo Manage documentation - Step-by-step instructions - Screenshots or examples - Common issues and troubleshooting

## Related topics

- Get answers (../../get-answers/index.html)

# What metrics matter?

Placeholder — Content to be completed

This topic will cover: KPI Manager/Viewer

Information needed: - Detailed workflow from Maximo Manage documentation - Step-by-step instructions - Screenshots or examples - Common issues and troubleshooting

## Related topics

- Get answers (../../get-answers/index.html)

# How do I act on alerts?

Placeholder — Content to be completed

This topic will cover: Operational Dashboards

Information needed: - Detailed workflow from Maximo Manage documentation - Step-by-step instructions - Screenshots or examples - Common issues and troubleshooting

## Related topics

- Get answers (../../get-answers/index.html)

# How do I assign the right people?

Placeholder — Content to be completed

This topic will cover: Labor, Crafts, Crews

Information needed: - Detailed workflow from Maximo Manage documentation - Step-by-step instructions - Screenshots or examples - Common issues and troubleshooting

## Related topics

- Get answers (../../get-answers/index.html)

# How do I standardize data?

Placeholder — Content to be completed

This topic will cover: Domains

Information needed: - Detailed workflow from Maximo Manage documentation - Step-by-step instructions - Screenshots or examples - Common issues and troubleshooting

## Related topics

- Get answers (../../get-answers/index.html)

# How do I get data into the system?

Placeholder — Content to be completed

This topic will cover: Data-loading tool

Information needed: - Detailed workflow from Maximo Manage documentation - Step-by-step instructions - Screenshots or examples - Common issues and troubleshooting

## Related topics

- Get answers (../../get-answers/index.html)

# How do I automate communication?

Placeholder — Content to be completed

This topic will cover: Communication Templates, Push Notifications

Information needed: - Detailed workflow from Maximo Manage documentation - Step-by-step instructions - Screenshots or examples - Common issues and troubleshooting

## Related topics

- Get answers (../../get-answers/index.html)

# How do I reduce downtime?

Placeholder — Content to be completed

This topic will cover: Best practices

Information needed: - Detailed workflow from Maximo Manage documentation - Step-by-step instructions - Screenshots or examples - Common issues and troubleshooting

## Related topics

- Get answers (../../get-answers/index.html)

# How do I improve completion rates?

Placeholder — Content to be completed

This topic will cover: Best practices

Information needed: - Detailed workflow from Maximo Manage documentation - Step-by-step instructions - Screenshots or examples - Common issues and troubleshooting

## Related topics

- Get answers (../../get-answers/index.html)

# Why does my data look wrong?

Placeholder — Content to be completed

This topic will cover: Data quality

Information needed: - Detailed workflow from Maximo Manage documentation - Step-by-step instructions - Screenshots or examples - Common issues and troubleshooting

## Related topics

- Get answers (../../get-answers/index.html)

# How do I make data reliable?

Placeholder — Content to be completed

This topic will cover: Data quality

Information needed: - Detailed workflow from Maximo Manage documentation - Step-by-step instructions - Screenshots or examples - Common issues and troubleshooting

## Related topics

- Get answers (../../get-answers/index.html)

# Why aren't technicians using the system?

Placeholder — Content to be completed

This topic will cover: Adoption

Information needed: - Detailed workflow from Maximo Manage documentation - Step-by-step instructions - Screenshots or examples - Common issues and troubleshooting

## Related topics

- Get answers (../../get-answers/index.html)

# How do I simplify workflows?

Placeholder — Content to be completed

This topic will cover: Adoption

Information needed: - Detailed workflow from Maximo Manage documentation - Step-by-step instructions - Screenshots or examples - Common issues and troubleshooting

## Related topics

- Get answers (../../get-answers/index.html)

# How can AI improve maintenance?

Placeholder — Content to be completed

This topic will cover: AI features

Information needed: - Detailed workflow from Maximo Manage documentation - Step-by-step instructions - Screenshots or examples - Common issues and troubleshooting

## Related topics

- Get answers (../../get-answers/index.html)

# What can I automate?

Placeholder — Content to be completed

This topic will cover: Automation

Information needed: - Detailed workflow from Maximo Manage documentation - Step-by-step instructions - Screenshots or examples - Common issues and troubleshooting

## Related topics

- Get answers (../../get-answers/index.html)

# How do I manage more assets?

Placeholder — Content to be completed

This topic will cover: Scaling

Information needed: - Detailed workflow from Maximo Manage documentation - Step-by-step instructions - Screenshots or examples - Common issues and troubleshooting

## Related topics

- Get answers (../../get-answers/index.html)

# How do I standardize across teams?

Placeholder — Content to be completed

This topic will cover: Scaling

Information needed: - Detailed workflow from Maximo Manage documentation - Step-by-step instructions - Screenshots or examples - Common issues and troubleshooting

## Related topics

- Get answers (../../get-answers/index.html)

# How do I turn data into decisions?

Placeholder — Content to be completed

This topic will cover: Analytics

Information needed: - Detailed workflow from Maximo Manage documentation - Step-by-step instructions - Screenshots or examples - Common issues and troubleshooting

## Related topics

- Get answers (../../get-answers/index.html)

# How do I optimize performance?

Placeholder — Content to be completed

This topic will cover: Analytics

Information needed: - Detailed workflow from Maximo Manage documentation - Step-by-step instructions - Screenshots or examples - Common issues and troubleshooting

## Related topics

- Get answers (../../get-answers/index.html)

# Get Answers

Find quick answers to common questions. All questions are organized by what you're trying to do.

## Browse by topic

### 🟦 Starting out

- What can I do with Maximo Select? (../start-fast/what-can-i-do/overview.html)
- What is an asset? (../start-fast/basics/what-is-asset.html)
- What is a work order? (../start-fast/basics/what-is-work-order.html)
- What is a location? (../start-fast/basics/what-is-location.html)

### 🟩 Getting work done

Planning work - How do I plan recurring maintenance? (../get-work-done/plan-work/plan-recurring-maintenance.html) - How do I decide what work should be done? (../get-work-done/plan-work/decide-what-work.html) - How do I schedule work? (../get-work-done/plan-work/schedule-work.html)

Completing work - How do I find my work? (../get-work-done/complete-work/find-work.html) - How do I complete a job? (../get-work-done/complete-work/complete-job.html) - What if I can't complete a task? (../get-work-done/complete-work/cant-complete-task.html)

Managing assets - How do I track asset history? (../get-work-done/manage-assets/track-asset-history.html) - How do I classify assets? (../get-work-done/manage-assets/classify-assets.html) - What happens when an asset fails? (../get-work-done/manage-assets/asset-fails.html)

Managing inventory - How do I issue parts to a job? (../get-work-done/manage-inventory/issue-parts.html) - How do I track stock levels? (../get-work-done/manage-inventory/track-stock-levels.html) - What happens if stock is incorrect? (../get-work-done/manage-inventory/stock-incorrect.html)

Monitoring and responding - How do I detect issues early? (../get-work-done/monitor-respond/detect-issues-early.html) - What metrics matter? (../get-work-done/monitor-respond/what-metrics-matter.html) - How do I act on alerts? (../get-work-done/monitor-respond/act-on-alerts.html)

Organizing people and work - How do I assign the right people? (../get-work-done/organize-people/assign-right-people.html) - How do I standardize data? (../get-work-done/organize-people/standardize-data.html)

Setting up and controlling - How do I get data into the system? (../get-work-done/setup-control/get-data-into-system.html) - How do I automate communication? (../get-work-done/setup-control/automate-communication.html)

### 🟨 Improving results

Improving work - How do I reduce downtime? (../improve-results/improve-work/reduce-downtime.html) - How do I improve completion rates? (../improve-results/improve-work/improve-completion-rates.html)

Improving data quality - Why does my data look wrong? (../improve-results/improve-data/data-looks-wrong.html) - How do I make data reliable? (../improve-results/improve-data/make-data-reliable.html)

Improving adoption - Why aren't technicians using the system? (../improve-results/improve-adoption/technicians-not-using.html) - How do I simplify workflows? (../improve-results/improve-adoption/simplify-workflows.html)

### 🟧 Working smarter

AI and automation - How can AI improve maintenance? (../work-smarter/ai-automation/ai-improve-maintenance.html) - What can I automate? (../work-smarter/ai-automation/what-can-automate.html)

Scaling operations - How do I manage more assets? (../work-smarter/scale-operation/manage-more-assets.html) - How do I standardize across teams? (../work-smarter/scale-operation/standardize-across-teams.html)

Insights and outcomes - How do I turn data into decisions? (../work-smarter/insights-outcomes/data-into-decisions.html) - How do I optimize performance? (../work-smarter/insights-outcomes/optimize-performance.html)

## Common troubleshooting

- Why can't I complete a work order? (../get-work-done/complete-work/cant-complete-task.html)
- Why is inventory showing negative stock? (../get-work-done/manage-inventory/stock-incorrect.html)
- Why does my data look wrong? (../improve-results/improve-data/data-looks-wrong.html)
- Why aren't technicians using the system? (../improve-results/improve-adoption/technicians-not-using.html)

## Still need help?

- In the product: Click the help icon (?) in the top right

- For a specific field: Click the field name or press Alt+F1
- Submit feedback: Use the feedback option in the help menu